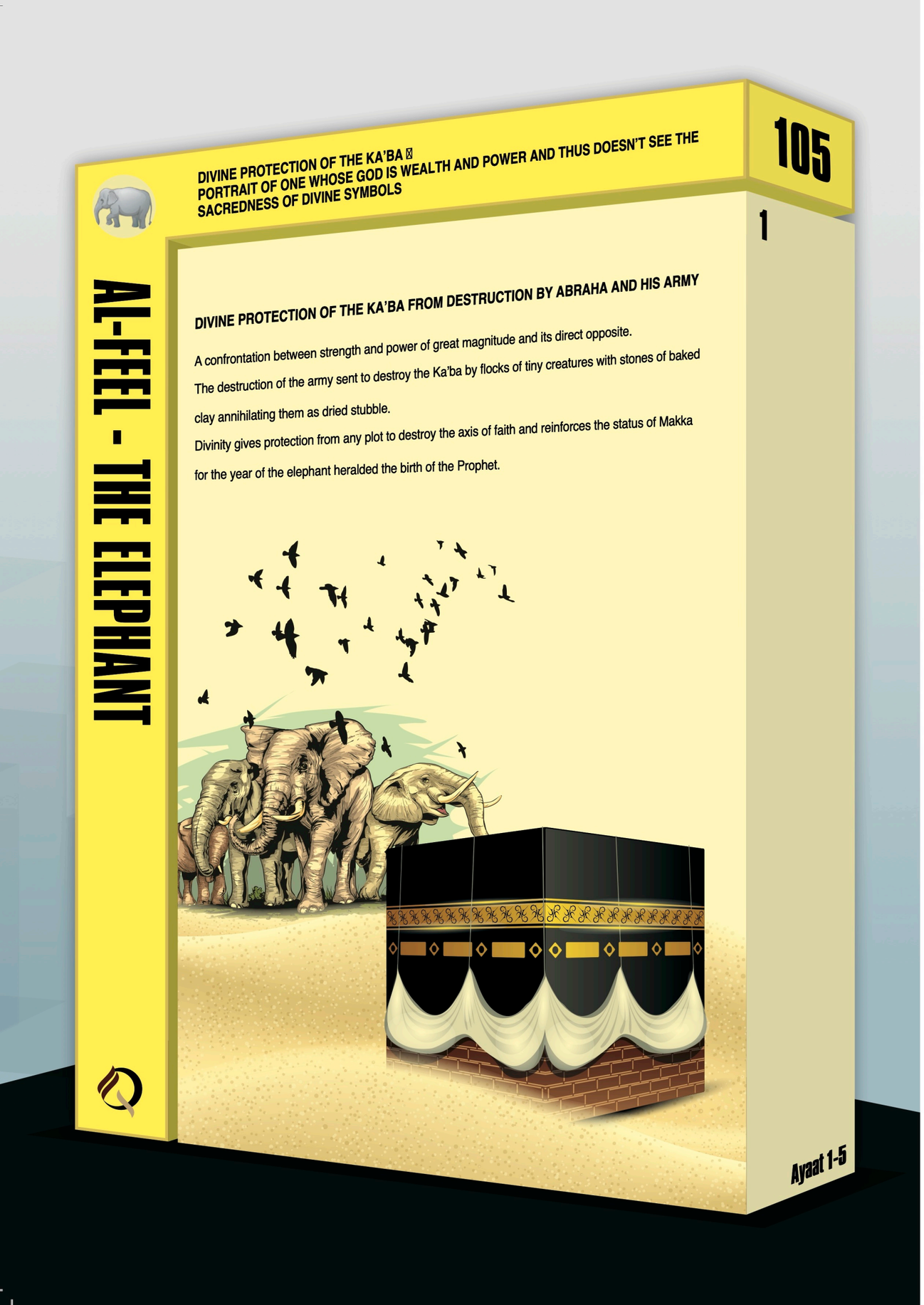

105. Al-Feel ~ The Elephant

5 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

DIVINE PROTECTION OF THE KA'BA
PORTRAIT OF ONE WHOSE GOD IS WEALTH AND POWER AND THUS DOESN'T SEE THE SACREDNESS OF DIVINE SYMBOLS

DID YOU KNOW?

MAKKA WAS AN ECONOMIC HUB UNIFYING THE ARABS. ABRAHA WAS BENT ON DESTROYING THE KA'BA TO ERADICATE ITS STATUS AND COLONISE THE REGION.

THIS EVENT GAVE MAKKA ITS INDEPENDENCE AND STATUS AND THE YEAR WAS CALLED 'THE YEAR OF THE ELEPHANT'. THE PROPHET WAS BORN IN THIS YEAR.

SELECTED AYAAT

105:1 Have you not considered how your Lord dealt with the troops of the elephant?

105:2 Did He not cause their strategy to end in confusion?

105:3 And send down flocks of flying creatures onto them.

105:4 Raining on them stones of baked clay.

105:5 Making them like consumed stubbles of grain.

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER TAKES ITS TITLE FROM THE DISCUSSION OF THE COMPANIONS OF THE ELEPHANT WHOSE DESTRUCTION IT RELATES.

THE GENERAL WHO RULED YEMEN NAMED ABRAHA, HAD BUILT AN OPULENT CHURCH IN SANA'A IN ORDER TO DIVERT PILGRIMS FROM THE KA'BA IN MAKKA. A NARRATION STATES THAT A FEW MEMBERS OF THE QURAYSH HAD GONE TO YEMEN AND DEFILED THE CHURCH.

WHEN THE VISITATIONS TO THE KA'BA WERE NOT ABANDONED, HE SENT AN ARMY WITH AN ELEPHANT TO DESTROY THE KA'BA. DIVINITY PROTECTED THE KA'BA BY SENDING A SWARM OF BIRDS THAT PELTED THE ARMY DESTROYING THEM.

THIS CHAPTER AND THE NEXT (AL QURAYSH 106) ARE A PAIR WHICH TOGETHER ARE A WARNING TO THE QURAYSH THAT THEY WERE PROTECTED NOT BECAUSE OF THEIR STATUS BUT BECAUSE ALLAH WISHED TO PROTECT THE KA'BA AND TO MAKE WAY FOR THE COMING OF HIS FINAL MESSENGER.